

How to RICE Linux

Nicola Bruno

December 30, 2025



Contents

Contents	2
1 Introduction	4
1.1 What is this book	4
1.2 Who is this book aimed at	4
1.3 What is inside this book?	4
2 Let's get started	5
2.1 Before we begin	5
2.2 What makes a system	5
The Operating System	6
The display server	7
The window manager	8
The bar	8
The application launcher	9
The terminal emulator	9
The shell	9
The file manager	10
The notification daemon	10
The compositor	11
The wallpaper	11
The color scheme	12
The fonts	12
The audio system	12
The music player	13
System monitor	14
The lockscreen	14
The power menu	14
Screenshots	15
Clipboard manager	15
Configuration Files	15
Dotfile Managment	15
Miscellaneous cool stuff	15
Browser	16
Application Theming	16
Scripts and Automation	16
Login Manager	16
2.3 Going Forward	16

3	Base Configuration	17
3.1	The Operating System	17
	Debian	17
	Arch	17
	Fedora	18
3.2	Display Server	18
	X11	18
	Wayland	18
3.3	Window Manager	19
	X11 Compatible	19
	Wayland Compatible	19
3.4	Status bar	20
	X11 Compatible	20
	Wayland Compatible	20
	Compatible with both	21
3.5	Application launcher	21
	X11 Compatible	21
	Wayland Compatible	22
3.6	Terminal emulator	22
3.7	Shell	22
3.8	Compositors	23
	X11 Compatible	23
	Wayland Compatible	23
3.9	Wallpaper Managers	23
	X11 Compatible	23
	Wayland Compatible	23
3.10	Configuration	24
	X11 with i3wm	24
	Picom	26
	Wayland with Sway	27
4	Style	29
4.1	Terminal	29
	Cursor	29
	Color	30
	Font	31
	Blur & Transparency	31

Chapter 4

Style

Now we will be covering some styling options, to make our setup not look like shit. Remember that this may differ depending on your components, so before changing your config, always consult the official documentation for your software.

4.1 Terminal

Since we will be doing all of our changes with a text editor that lives inside the terminal, it makes sense to customize it first. We will be doing this by changing:

- Cursor
- Colors
- Font
- Blur & Transparency
- Scale
- Misc

Everything we will need is inside the configuration file for the terminal emulator, which should already be inside `/.config/kitty/kitty.conf`

Cursor

Whoever uses the block style cursor is either very old and nostalgic, or a complete psychopath, so we need the I-Beam style. To to this we need to change

```
cursor_shape block
```

To

```
cursor_shape beam
```

Color

Now that we can actually use the terminal and edit text without dying, we can change the colors. We will be doing the "main" colors first, and the other colors after. So first we need the text color, the background color, and the cursor color. This is really simple, it's just a matter of adding a hex code to a line:

Main colors

```
#foreground is the text color
foreground #ffffff
#background is the terminal's background color
background #000000
#cursor is the cursor color, again, what a surprise!
cursor #ffffff
```

Now that our text¹ is white and the background is black, we can move on to the other colors

Secondary colors

The terminal now is readable, but is very basic. Let's add some paint to it. Our terminal of choice has a 16 color palette, with 8 dull colors and 8 bright ones. You can customize the whole palette of the 256 terminal colors, but the basic ones are:

- Black

```
color0 #000000
color8 #767676
```

- Red

```
color1 #cc0403
color9 #f2201f
```

- Green

```
color2 #cecb00
color10 #fffd00
```

- Yellow

```
color3 #0d73cc
color11 #1a8fff
```

¹I recommend setting the cursor color the same as the foreground, for visibility reasons, but you do not have to do so

- Blue

```
color4 #cb1ed1
color12 #1a8fff
```

- Magenta

```
color5 #0dcddc
color13 #f228ff
```

- Cyan

```
color6 #0dcddc
color14 #14ffff
```

- White

```
color7 #dddddd
color15 #ffffff
```

These are the default ones, feel free to change them however you see fit

Font

Changing font is also really simple

```
#this is the actual font, in this case, the Ubuntu one
font_family Adwaita Mono
#these are the specific mods
bold_font auto
italic_font auto
bold_italic_font auto
```

Blur & Transparency

It's not a real Linux rice if your terminal is opaque. Unless you're going for that vibe, in which case, just skip ahead. To change Transparency and Blur just change the homonymous rule:

```
# 1.0 means fully opaque, 0 means fully transparent
background_opacity 0.8
# 0 means no blur, increase to preference
background_blur 4
```

Scale

You may need to have a bigger or smaller text inside the terminal. For this we will set a default one, and keybinds to increase and decrease it by intervals

Misc